Hariharan Manikkam

Komarapalayam, India
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🎂 Date of Birth: 6 January 2004 | Age: 20 | Male

Objective

Imaginative and introspective **Psychological Fiction & Screenwriter** with a Master's in Psychology and a passion for crafting compelling narratives that explore the depths of the human mind. Expert in scripting emotionally layered dialogues, creating psychologically rich characters, and constructing suspense-driven plots. Currently scripting original content for **Hotstar Specials (Disney+ Hotstar)** with a focus on psychological thrillers and character-driven dramas.

Education

Master of Arts (M.A.) in Psychology
Loyola College, Chennai
Graduated: **15 May 2024**

- Specialized in cognitive and behavioral psychology, narrative psychology, and abnormal psychology.
- Dissertation on **"Character Archetypes in Psychological Fiction: A Study of Narrative Mindsets"**.

Bachelor of Arts in English Literature
PSG College of Arts and Science, Coimbatore
Graduated: **May 2022**

Professional Experience

Psychological Fiction / Screenwriter

Hotstar Specials (Disney+ Hotstar)
July 2024 – Present

- Developed scripts for original psychological thriller series, such as **"Shadows Within"** and **"Mind Loop"**, currently streaming on Hotstar.
- Created characters with deep-rooted mental conflict and authenticity, using psychological theory to guide emotional arcs and development.
- Collaborated with directors and producers to shape storyboards, pacing, and suspense-driven narrative beats.
- Wrote emotionally resonant and psychologically complex dialogues, praised for realism and subtlety.
- Worked on show bibles and episode treatments in pre-production and pitch decks.

Key Skills

- 🧠 Psychological Fiction & Thriller Screenwriting
- ✍️ Character Psychology & Development
- 🎭 Emotionally Driven Dialogue Writing
- 📖 Storyboarding & Episode Structuring
- 🎬 Genre-Specific Writing (Drama, Suspense, Mystery)
- 📚 Narrative Flow & Subconscious Symbolism
- 💡 Creative Collaboration & Pitch Presentation

Tools & Technologies

- **Screenwriting Software**: Final Draft, Celtx, WriterDuet
- **Plot Design Tools**: Milanote, Notion, Scrivener
- **Research Tools**: JSTOR, APA PsycInfo, Medium
- **Storyboarding & Visual Scripting**: Canva, StudioBinder
- **Presentation Tools**: Google Slides, Microsoft PowerPoint

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Achievements & Highlights

- 🏆 Scripted **"Shadows Within"** – a psychological mini-series that received 8.7 ⭐ IMDb rating and was nominated for **Best Original Web Series – Asian Web Awards 2025**.
- 🧩 Finalist – **Screenwriters Guild of India Short Script Contest 2024** for *"The Third Self"*.
- 📘 Author of the short fiction anthology **"Fragmented Minds"**, sold over 3,000 copies digitally.
- 🎤 Guest speaker at **Mind & Ink 2025**, discussing **"Building Realism in Mental Health Fiction"**.
- 📝 Contributed articles on narrative psychology to **The Storyteller's Journal** and **Writer's Lab India**.

Key Projects

- **Shadows Within** *(Hotstar Originals)* – 6-episode psychological thriller exploring dissociative identity disorder.
- **Echoes of a Silent Mind** – Scripted short film that was featured at **Venice Shorts Film Awards (2024)**.
- **Mind Loop** *(In Development)* – Conceptual psychological thriller based on memory manipulation and time perception.

Personal Details

- **Date of Birth:** 6 January 2004
- **Gender:** Male
- **Nationality:** Indian
- **Address:** Komarapalayam, India